

9.13.3 General Instruction for Legal Consideration

- Always check patient's identification tag
- Ask patient to state their name and birth date.
- Compare medication order to identification tag and patient's stated name and birth date.
- Verify patient's allergies with chart and with patient.
- Perform a triple check of the medication's label
  - When retrieving the medication.
  - When preparing the medication.
  - Before administering medication to patient.
- Always check the medication label with the physician's orders.
- Never administer medication prepared by another person
- Never administer medication that is not labeled
- Check label for medication concentration.
- Compare prepared dose with medication order.
- Triple all medication calculations.
- Check all medication calculations with another nurse.
- Verify that dosage is within appropriate dose range for patient and medication.
- Verify schedule of medication with order.
  - Date
  - Time
  - Specified period of time
- Check last dose of medication given to patient.
- Administer medication within 30 minutes of schedule.
- Verify medication route with medication order before administering.
- Medication may only be administered via route specified in order
- Inform patient of medication being administered.

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